

Methodology – DeepThought Business Analytics Assignment

Objective

The objective of this assignment was to identify and evaluate companies in Hyderabad that fit DeepThought's Ideal Customer Profile (ICP), referred to as a "Federer Company". These are growth-oriented, founder-driven organizations that build capabilities in-house, operate through structured systems, and demonstrate evidence of operational maturity.

City Selected

Hyderabad

Industry Segments Selected

1. Specialty Chemicals
2. Medical Devices

Research Process

The research process was conducted in five stages.

Stage 1: Initial Company Discovery

An initial list of companies was created using multiple public sources including company websites, LinkedIn, industry directories, news articles, and business databases.

The goal was to build a broad universe of potential companies operating within the selected segments.

Stage 2: Eligibility Screening

Each company was evaluated against DeepThought's mandatory eligibility criteria.

E1 – Producer:

The company must manufacture products or operate specialized infrastructure in-house.

E2 – Accessible:

The company must have significant operational presence in India.

Companies failing either criterion were removed from further consideration.

Stage 3: Deep Research

For companies passing the eligibility stage, detailed research was conducted using:

- Company websites
- LinkedIn profiles
- News articles and press releases
- Annual reports (where available)
- MCA and public business databases
- Industry publications

Research focused on identifying evidence related to differentiation, leadership quality, sector tailwinds, growth activity, systems maturity, and leadership depth.

Stage 4: Federer Scoring

Each company was evaluated using the Federer scoring framework.

Criteria included:

- C3: Differentiation
- C4: Decision-Maker Quality
- C5: Growing Sector
- C6: Growth Signals
- C7: Systems Maturity
- C8: Leadership Succession

Companies were scored using the Strong / Moderate / Weak framework described in the assignment.

Stage 5: Final Shortlisting

Companies with the strongest combination of differentiation, growth signals, operational systems, and leadership quality were shortlisted.

The final output consists of 25 companies that best fit DeepThought's target customer profile.

AI Usage

AI tools were used for discovery, summarization, and idea generation.

All critical information including company details, growth signals, leadership information, and scoring evidence was manually verified using primary and secondary sources before inclusion in the final dataset.

Key Learning

The research highlighted that strong Federer companies are typically characterized by:

- Technical differentiation
- Structured operations
- Leadership depth
- Growth-oriented founders
- Continuous investment in capability building

Systems maturity was one of the strongest indicators of DeepThought ICP fit.